

COMPLAINT NO. 2022-00060

IN THE MATTER OF

FORD JONES

§ BEFORE THE TEXAS BEHAVIORAL  
§ HEALTH EXECUTIVE COUNCIL  
§  
§ THE TEXAS STATE BOARD  
§ OF EXAMINERS OF  
§ PROFESSIONAL COUNSELORS

**AGREED ORDER**

Pursuant to the authority under §507.305 of the Texas Occupations Code, §2001.056 of the Government Code, and 22 Texas Administrative Code §884.12(e), the Executive Director for the Texas Behavioral Health Executive Council ("Council") hereby approves, ratifies, and enters this Agreed Order with the following Findings of Fact, Conclusions of Law, and Order of the Council, which have been approved and accepted by **FORD JONES** ("Respondent") and which constitutes a full settlement and compromise of the complaint(s) currently pending against Respondent before the Council in the above-referenced and numbered matter(s).

**FINDINGS OF FACT**

1. Respondent is licensed as a professional counselor (#68507) in the State of Texas and is, therefore, subject to the jurisdiction of the Council.
2. In September and October 2021, Respondent allowed a client to move into his home for a period of approximately one month.

**CONCLUSIONS OF LAW**

1. Respondent voluntarily received a license from the Council and, therefore, is bound by the provisions of Chapters 503 and 507 of the Texas Occupations Code and the Rules of the Council, 22 Texas Administrative Code Parts 30 and 41.
2. Violation of the Council's Rules is unprofessional conduct and constitutes grounds for the imposition of sanctions under §§503.401, 507.301, and 507.351 of the Texas Occupations Code.
3. Based on the above Findings of Fact, the Council finds that Respondent violated 22 Tex. Admin. Code §§ 681.41(l)(2021 edition), and 681.41(m)(2021 edition).
4. This Agreed Order is a Settlement Agreement under the Texas Rules of Evidence and is not admissible for the purposes of civil litigation. By entering into this Agreed Order, Respondent does not admit the foregoing Findings of Fact or Conclusions of Law, but agrees to resolve this matter to avoid the expense and uncertainty of further proceedings.

### ORDER

#### **IT IS HEREBY ORDERED, ADJUDGED, AND DECREED THAT:**

1. Respondent's license is SUSPENDED for a period of six (6) months from the effective date of this order. However, the six (6) months of suspension shall be PROBATED, so long as Respondent complies with all state and federal statutes and regulations pertaining to the practice of counseling. Although the probated suspension ordered herein will result in Respondent's license being restricted, Respondent shall take all steps necessary to renew and maintain Respondent's license while this order is in effect. Respondent's license shall remain on restricted status until all terms of this order have been satisfactorily completed.
2. Respondent is assessed and shall pay, within thirty (30) days of the date this order is ratified, an administrative penalty in the total amount of \$1,000.00; of which \$800.00 represents administrative costs and \$200.00 represents administrative penalty.
3. Respondent, within thirty (30) days of the date this order is ratified, shall complete and submit proof of completion of the following professional development: four (4) hours of professional development regarding counseling boundaries; four (4) hours of professional development regarding collaborating with other agencies; and four (4) hours of professional development regarding professional ethics. Respondent will pay all costs of the coursework.

### WARNING

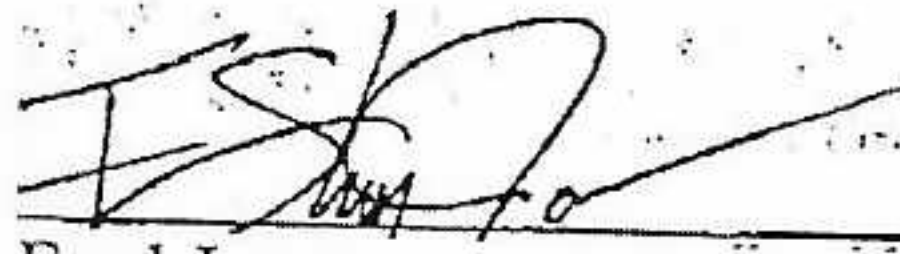
**RESPONDENT'S FAILURE TO COMPLY WITH ONE OR MORE TERMS OF THIS ORDER MAY CONSTITUTE A VIOLATION OF 22 TEXAS ADMINISTRATIVE CODE §884.55 REQUIRING FURTHER DISCIPLINARY ACTION.**

### WAIVERS

On the underlying investigative file, Respondent has waived his or her right to an informal settlement conference, a formal hearing before an Administrative Law Judge at the State Office of Administrative Hearings (SOAH), and judicial review pursuant to Texas Government Code Chapter 2001, in exchange for the conditions set out in this Agreed Order.

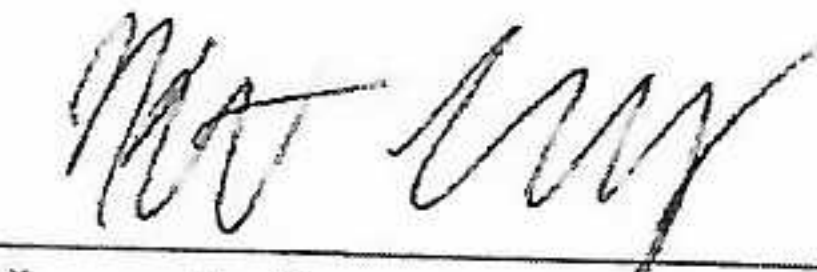
THE RESPONDENT, BY SIGNING THIS ORDER, AGREES TO ITS TERMS, ACKNOWLEDGES UNDERSTANDING OF THE FORMAL NOTICES, FINDINGS OF FACT, AND CONCLUSIONS OF LAW SET FORTH HEREIN AND COVENANTS TO SATISFACTORILY COMPLY WITH THE MANDATES OF THIS ORDER IN A TIMELY MANNER. RESPONDENT FURTHER ACKNOWLEDGES AND AGREES THAT HE OR SHE HAS AGREED TO THIS ORDER UPON THE ADVICE AND CONSENT OF COUNSEL, OR THAT HE OR SHE HAS HAD THE OPPORTUNITY TO HAVE THIS ORDER REVIEWED BY COUNSEL OF HIS OR HER CHOICE.

FOR THE RESPONDENT:

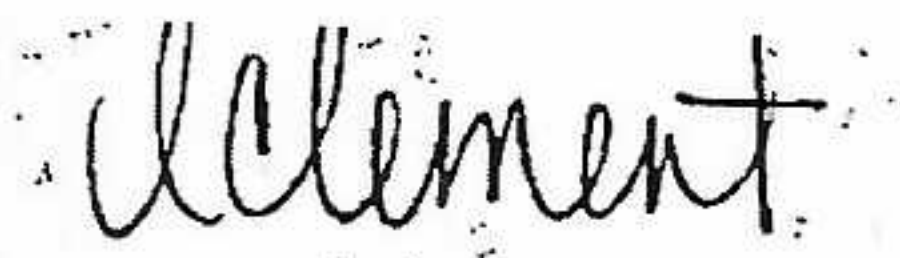
  
Ford Jones  
Licensed Professional Counselor  
License Number 68507

DATE SIGNED: 5/23/2024

FOR THE STAFF OF THE COUNCIL:

  
Kenneth Long  
Texas Bar No. 24078877  
Staff Attorney  
Texas Behavioral Health Executive Council  
1801 Congress Ave., Ste. 7.300  
Austin TX 78701

DATE SIGNED: 5/23/2024

  
Laurel Clement, Attorney

APPROVED, RATIFIED, AND ENTERED THIS 23rd DAY OF May, 2024.

  
Darrel Spinks  
Executive Director  
Texas Behavioral Health Executive Council